

visit.brussels

Activity report 2024



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1. Introduction

visit.brussels ASBL is the Brussels promotion and communications agency dedicated to:

- promoting tourism, culture and events in the Brussels-Capital Region
- creating experiences that leverage its many assets
- offering a warm welcome to visitors, from leisure and business travellers to international associations

We energise the city and create unique experiences for visitors and residents alike.

1.1. Figures

Hotel occupancy rate



72,7%

+2,8 points vs 2023

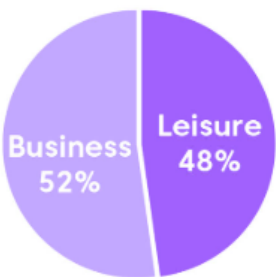
Number of overnight stays



9,73 million

April 2025 estimate*

Breakdown of overnight



2023 : 51% business; 49% leisure



Over 100

sustainable partners
(including 70 Green Key)**



8,38/10

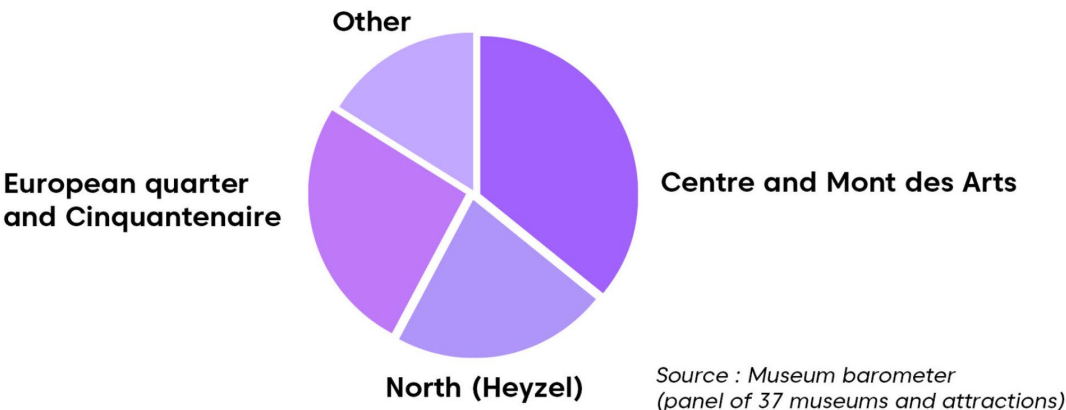
Satisfaction rate
2023***



6,4 million

visitors of museums and
attractions****

Geographical breakdown of visitors to museums and attractions



- * + 3,62% vs 2023 : 9.389.831 overnight stays
 - Hotels and youth hostels: 7,486,705 overnight stays (+4.24% vs 2023: 7,182,457)
 - Collaborative economy platforms: 2,239,438 overnight stays (+1.45% vs 2023: 2,207,374)
- ** +14% vs 2023
- *** 2022 : 8,33/10
- **** museums: 5,02 million - +2% compared with the record year of 2023

Interview Patrick Bontinck-CEO



A look back at 2024

2024 marked a turning point for tourism in Brussels, with all early estimates pointing to this year surpassing the record figures of 2019. These encouraging results are evidence of the collective efforts of the visit.brussels teams and the relevance of the actions taken to boost the region's attractiveness.

This success is particularly apparent in our digital presence, with some notable results: 4 million visitors to the visit.brussels portal, a community of 700,000 social media followers and a spectacular 447% increase in Google searches about Brussels.

This performance translates into tangible economic returns for the region. In fact, every public euro invested in tourism generates significant benefits, contributing substantially to Brussels' GDP and local job creation. In addition, our improved digital strategies have considerably enhanced our capital's visibility on digital platforms.

As part of this innovative approach, we have used ERDF funding to develop a centralised ticketing service connecting almost 150 cultural institutions. This initiative is particularly relevant for a city of 1.2 million residents with such a rich and diverse range of cultural activities. The introduction of "last minute" offers reinforces our commitment to making culture accessible to all audiences. This shift to digital access to culture represents a

major step forward for Brussels, making it easier for residents and visitors alike to explore and participate in cultural life.

Challenges for 2025

As a leading tourist destination, Brussels is fully committed to a Smart Tourism approach, with the ambition of building a visitor economy that generates positive impact—for the benefit of the city, its residents, and its visitors alike. This transformation, driven by the opportunities offered by digital technology and artificial intelligence, goes beyond enhancing the tourist experience: it also aims to create lasting value for the entire local ecosystem.

In line with this vision, visit.brussels is implementing a comprehensive strategy that embraces the principles of sustainability accessibility, and the promotion of cultural heritage. Every project undertaken contributes to this ambition: to support the development of respectful, inclusive, and enriching tourism—economically, socially, and environmentally.

Visit.brussels, supported by ERDF funds, is deploying this strategy through innovative initiatives that redefine the tourist experience. An initial ERDF project will use artificial intelligence to enhance the accessibility of Brussels museums with content in different European languages and explanations adapted to different audiences. A second ERDF project will offer a truly intelligent digital passport. This next-generation card will no longer be limited to museum access, but will include public transport, ticketing and various tourist and cultural experiences in Brussels. It will also provide personalised recommendations based on various criteria such as visitor traffic and interests. This will facilitate a better distribution of tourist flows in the city.

These technological innovations are part of a broader vision for sustainable and responsible tourism. By optimising visitor routes and encouraging the discovery of less-frequented neighbourhoods, we can contribute to a balanced tourism development that benefits the entire Brussels region. This Smart Tourism approach can therefore help to reconcile the appeal of tourism with quality of life for local residents, creating a virtuous and inclusive visitor economy.

2.Brussels' image

In 2024, visit.brussels orchestrated a series of strategic initiatives to promote Brussels as a top destination, targeting both visitors and tourism professionals. visit.brussels strengthened the capital's image on the international stage through a robust city marketing strategy, international actions and promotional campaigns. These visit.brussels initiatives included efforts focused in particular on mobilising and promoting Brussels' nightlife, notably through the Brussels Night Council.



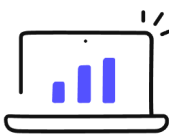
18th

Europe's Best Cities
2023 ranking (top 100)



46 million

impressions for the
various 2024 campaigns



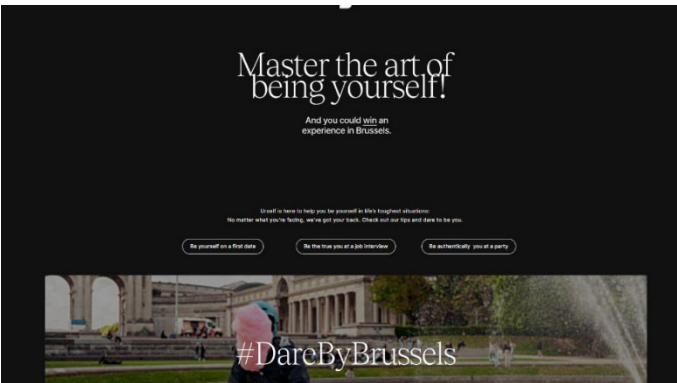
100.000

visits

to the Nightlife section
of the website (+43%)

2.1. Brussels brand and international city marketing

In 2024, the main objective was to promote Brussels' unique assets abroad. A promotional campaign, entitled *Urself*, was launched targeting "originators" in the English, Spanish, Italian and German markets. This initiative generated significant results, with 25.5 million impressions, 51,000 views, and 40,000 unique users on the dedicated website (urself.brussels).



At the same time, efforts were made to mobilise and activate public and private stakeholders via the Steering Committee. This met every six weeks to monitor project progress, share feedback and respond to strategic and creative needs.

Key actions included:

- **Developing a shared brand:** updating the toolbox, storytelling and visual identity.

- **Reprinting the Photobook:** produced to accompany Belgium's presidency of the EU and the European elections, in partnership with the Brussels Chamber of Commerce (BECI) and the Commissioner for Europe and International Organizations (CEOI).
- **Workshops and information sessions:** organisation of "open house" sessions and specific workshops (MICE sector, hospitality, etc.) with the support of Resonance.

These initiatives have boosted the visibility and positive perception of Brussels on the international stage.

2.2. Brussels Houses

Brussels Houses are the result of a collaboration between visit.brussels and hub.brussels to create a space that brings the Brussels community together internationally while promoting the attractiveness and expertise of Brussels. These spaces, in which visit.brussels applied the concepts of the international BRUSSELS brand, embody the image of a dynamic, innovative, creative Brussels that is open to the world. The Brussels Houses in Milan and Barcelona serve as showcases for Brussels' products and lifestyle, offering a sensory insight into the Region through immersive staging and marking an important step in the international promotion of Brussels.

2024 was a year of consolidation for the latest two Brussels Houses which hosted numerous events to promote tourism and the Brussels economy (including two Arty Brussels events in Milan and Barcelona, designed to highlight the contemporary art sector among journalists).

2.3. The Brussels Region AT MIPIM

The world's largest forum for real estate professionals, MIPIM, illustrates Brussels' ambitions in the real estate sector. It brings together major players and highlights the Region's development projects in partnership with the Walloon Region and private sector representatives. In 2024, this forum saw the addition of a number of new features including a conference with contributions from the Embuild.Brussels and UPSI/BVS employers' federations, as well as case studies in the form of a keynote speaker (on the MIX project) and a moderator for the round table.

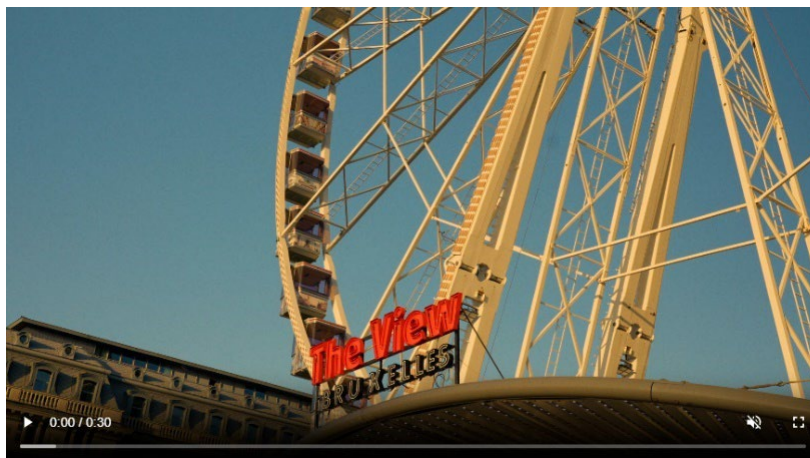
20-minute pitch sessions were held on the Brussels-Capital Region stand. These provided a platform for interested **Public Interest Organisations (PIOs)** and Brussels-based project developers nominated for the **MIPIM Awards**. The stand also hosted the **Business Review**, organised by the **SLRB**, **SAU** and **Citydev** to raise the profile of regional initiatives.



2.4. B2C communication campaigns

Visit.brussels dynamically promoted the cultural and tourist scene exclusively through in-house communication campaigns, covering aspects such as gastronomy, artisanal shopping and the cultural offer. The marketing strategy has been designed to ensure that each message is delivered to the right audience at the right time to maximise its impact: *"the right message to the right audience at the right time"*.

In 2024, several national and international B2C communication campaigns were carried out to promote Brussels as a must-visit destination. The **Winter Campaign** showcased the city's assets during off-peak periods, generating 8 million impressions, 72,000 clicks, and 14,500 visits to the landing page, while encouraging a better spread of tourism over time.



The **Culture/Lifestyle campaign** targeted Belgium, France and Italy, with excellent results in Italy, including 18.8 million impressions, 2.69 million completed video plays and 71,000 clicks, confirming this market's potential.

These initiatives have helped to raise Brussels' profile, engage target audiences and encourage sustainable, quality tourism.



2.5. Brussels Night Council and nightlife promotion

Brussels' nightlife, essential to the Region's attractiveness and the inclusion of young people (aged 18-35), was the subject of a specific visit.brussels strategy. The objective was to position Brussels as a desirable and safe nightlife destination.

The promotion of Brussels' nightlife has increased through social networking campaigns, media partnerships and direct support for clubs, festivals and open air concerts. Events such as Listenfestival, Hangar and Rave Rebels have been a resounding success, while the Volume Pass has begun to generate promising results, supporting clubs and the local cultural scene.

The nightlife section recorded 100,000 visits, up 43% on the 70,000 visits in 2023. The number of page views also rose, reaching 130,000 in 2024, compared with 99,000 in 2023, an increase of 31%. In addition, the number of unique visitors grew by 38% from 60,000 in 2023 to 83,000 in 2024.

These results confirm the growing interest in Brussels' nightlife and the effectiveness of the actions taken to boost its visibility and appeal.

The Brussels Night Council, hosted by visit.brussels, organised seven round tables on a variety of themes designed to promote a dynamic, balanced and safe nightlife for Brussels residents and visitors. This year saw the preparation of the Regional Nightlife Plan (PRVN) for the 2025-2029 legislature. The result of extensive consultation with public, voluntary, institutional and private stakeholders, the plan comprises 14 actions

designed to enhance safety and reduce risks, ensure regional governance and greater integration of party venues while limiting disturbances and supporting the nightlife sector.



2.6. Marketing strategy

In 2024, visit.brussels continued to develop its marketing strategy to boost Brussels' attractiveness, using an approach based on customer segment knowledge and customer journey analysis. Two separate marketing plans, B2C and B2B, were drawn up to define the destination's strategic directions and key messages, while a detailed study of 1,200 Belgians laid the foundations for a specific marketing plan for Belgium in 2025.

2024 was also marked by several significant advances, notably the complete revision of our [tourism barometers](#). These were brought together in a single, more intuitive and readable dashboard, designed to provide our partners and employees with as much relevant information as possible.

Visit.brussels has also carried out a number of studies, including a survey on how Brussels residents perceive tourism. These studies assess [visitor satisfaction](#) and the [perception of tourism among Brussels inhabitants](#), respectively.

3. Leisure tourism

In 2024, visit.brussels' commitment to offering a quality tourism experience was demonstrated through a range of initiatives and products aimed at promoting Brussels as a first-rate cultural and tourist destination.



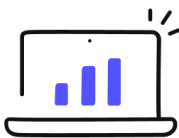
**€322,5
million**

in estimated press
coverage



1150

participants in partner
meetings and Quality
Academy sessions**



3,71 million

website visitors***

** €322.5 million in estimated media coverage impact (including €62.5 million in national media: equivalent to the year 2023)*

*** +60% vs. 2023*

**** +13% vs. 2023*

3.1. Tourist information offices and tools

At a time when information is just a click away, visit.brussels is changing the role of tourist information offices by strengthening the expertise of its agents and decentralising its services, thereby confirming its role as a multilingual information hub for the general public.

The experience of visitors to our two information offices and our experience.brussels exhibition has been enhanced by renovations and a more welcoming design, including renewed signage. In addition, visit.brussels launched a unique collaboration with the passenger centres of four Brussels stations; we are training SNCB agents to provide tourist advice to visitors, in a bid to improve their experience from the moment they arrive.

Our number of interactions with visitors remains high: 79,000 interactions with our optimised content across a network of 50 interactive terminals, plus 281,000 contacts, including 268,000 people welcomed at our offices. We are actively reducing waiting times by adjusting staffing to statistical visitor forecasts, optimising telephone, email and chat responses and gradually integrating generative AI.



We improved our sales figures for [guides and maps](#) by around 4.5%, with a record 43,000 copies sold. We created a new "Walk with Tintin" map (the result of a partnership with Tintinimagination) available in three languages (FR/NL/EN), as well as a "Brussels, architecture and panoramas" guide (in 6 languages). Furthermore, 475,000 copies of desk maps were distributed via recognised accommodation providers. These results demonstrate visitors' growing interest in our publications, which are available at 14 distribution outlets.



3.2. Tourism products

In 2024, visit.brussels maintained its flagship tourism products that together promoted cultural discovery, sustainable tourism and tourism decentralisation.

The [Brussels Card](#) remained at the heart of this dynamic, with 18,870 cards sold. This card provides easy access to museums and attractions at reduced prices. Its existence is a testament to visit.brussels' commitment to an enriching and accessible tourist experience.

According to the 2023 *Reputation Tracker* report by TCI Research & TravelSat, Brussels' attractions received very satisfactory ratings, with a particular distinction for the guided tours, appreciated for the friendliness of the staff and the quality of the entertainment. In response, 2024 also focuses on these stakeholders by strengthening interactions and

partnerships with the guided tours sector, aiming to boost their visibility and enhance their services.

The initiative related to the deployment of [Greeters](#) was a great success, with 381 walks organised in their company. This popular activity received an excellent satisfaction rate of 98.5%. 15 new greeters joined the teams in 2024.

In addition, visit.brussels' development of products and experiences involved the [promotion of local gastronomic delights](#) in Brussels, including the famous Best Shrimp Croquette competition, the awarding of our "Brusselicious" label recognising the best local cuisine in our capital (awarded to 36 Brussels establishments). We should also mention the complete redesign of our website for restaurants. Meanwhile, the [Volume Pass](#) enables visitors to experience the full wealth of Brussels' nightlife at a reasonable price.



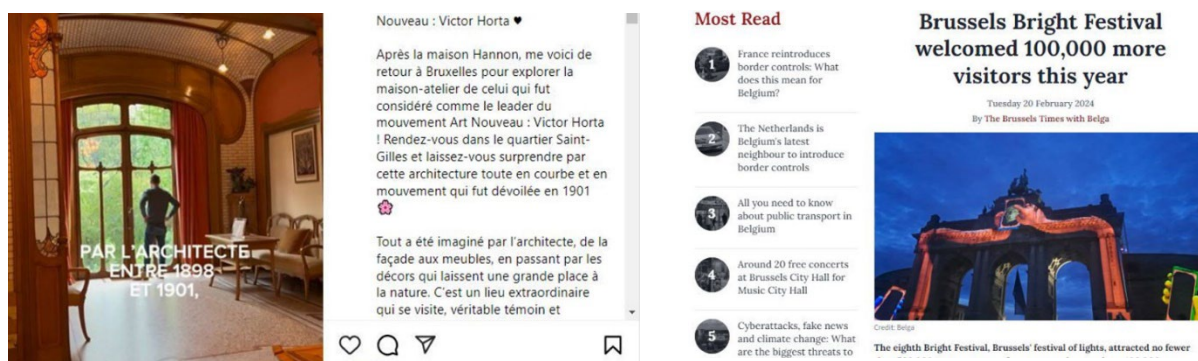
3.3. National and international tourism communication

In 2024, visit.brussels actively promoted Brussels on the international scene with a dynamic strategy of communication campaigns, press actions and collaboration with national and international influencers.

Various communication campaigns were orchestrated by visit.brussels in 2024. Some of these were aimed specifically at the expatriate population in Brussels, or at art lovers, as part of communication campaigns to mark the anniversary of the Surrealist art movement. These different communication campaigns met with resounding success: 1,058,600 impressions as part of the BXLconnect 2024 campaign, targeting the "expat" community.

Playing a decisive role in promoting Brussels, social media and influencers were, once again this year, used to raise our capital's profile. Paid promotional campaigns (via [Facebook](#) and [Instagram](#)) achieved spectacular results with 5,237,710 views of promotional videos. In addition, some twenty collaborations with well-known national

and international influencers helped to promote their image and experience during their visit to Brussels, reaching more than 11.82 million people.



Support for the national press, designed to encourage Belgians to visit Brussels, also included partnerships with flagship programmes such as *Les Ambassadeurs* on La Une/RTBF and *De Weekwatchers* on Radio 2/VRT. In 2024, over 100 interviews were conducted and more than 60 press releases issued. In total, almost 3,100 print articles and 6,700 articles in the national press were published, representing a total media value of €62.5 million.

Visit.brussels also organised press trips, welcoming nearly 250 foreign journalists and handling over 100 requests for information and support from journalists visiting Brussels. The practical implications of the press trips and managing the requests generated international press coverage worth €260 million.

3.4. Partner events

In 2024, the definition of "partner" was revised so as to strengthen collaboration with those involved in the tourism and culture sectors in Brussels. A charter was also established to clarify and reinforce their role as ambassadors, improve the quality of services and guarantee a positive impact on the city.

A total of 1,150 partners, including public bodies, cultural and tourism managers and local authorities, were met at events, sectoral or themed round tables and training courses. Major events, such as Brussels Insight in September, systematically bring together around a hundred participants and are intended to inform, co-create, inspire, network and promote partners. In addition, some thirty themed meetings, each attended by between 10 and 60 participants, provided an opportunity to deepen partnerships on specific topics such as sustainability, accreditations, intermunicipal cooperation, contemporary art, cultural stakeholders and media, the performing arts, guided tours, heritage and gastronomy.

The Quality Academy aims to offer year-round certified training courses that enhance the skills of Brussels' hospitality professionals (tourism staff, catering, cultural facilities) with a view to improving the welcome and promotion of Brussels tourism.

The **visit.brussels Awards** ceremony at TRACK Brussels honoured seven outstanding initiatives that contributed to the Region's international reputation and elevated the visitor experience. The event, celebrating innovation and excellence in the Brussels tourism sector, was attended by **180 guests**.

Other key events enriched this dynamic, notably **Career Day**, a chance for 70 students to meet 10 industry professionals with around ten presentations and events for students at colleges and universities. In addition, there were some ten presentations to expat audiences through European institutions and NATO.

Overall, there has been increased participation in partner events, reflecting a growing interest and greater loyalty among participants, due to awareness initiatives.



3.5. Travel trade and carrier partnerships

In 2024, visit.brussels strengthened its partnerships with rail and air carriers to improve Brussels' accessibility and attractiveness. The extension of European Sleeper's Prague-Brussels route was supported by promotional campaigns, while the merger of Eurostar and Thalys positioned the capital as a major rail hub. In terms of air travel, new intercontinental routes were launched in partnership with Brussels Airlines, Singapore Airlines, ANA Airways and Thai Airways, through promotion agreements and networking events.

In the Travel Trade sector, visit.brussels stepped up its presence in European, North American and overseas markets. In Europe, there were targeted campaigns in **France, Germany, the UK, Spain and Italy**, reaching thousands of qualified contacts.

In the **United States**, the focus was on MICE, with a successful sales mission. New partnerships with airlines are planned for 2025.

On the **distant markets** (Brazil, India, Japan), visit.brussels worked with local agencies and Brussels Airport to consolidate its presence. In India, more than 30 programmes now include Brussels, while in Brazil, 70 programmes have been developed. 5,000 qualified contacts were recorded in Brazil and 3,500 in India. In Japan, a concerted approach with Brussels Airport and the other Belgian regions led to a structured engagement strategy with TOs and OTAs to increase Brussels' appearances in international catalogues.

Such initiatives have established Brussels as a must-visit destination, boosting its appeal to tourism professionals and international travellers alike.



4. Business tourism

In 2024, visit.brussels boosted Brussels' visibility and attractiveness on the international market through targeted strategic initiatives, including participation in international trade fairs, the deployment of MICE sales initiatives, support for congress, trade show and event organisers and the activation of the Ambassador Programme. Each of these actions helped to promote Brussels as a destination of choice for tourism and business events.



609

conference/event
requests processed by
the Convention Bureau*



2,278

**business
meetings**

held/organised on our
stands by visit.brussels
and its partners**



#1

Brussels UIA ranking***

* +1.8% vs. 2023

** vs. 1,940 In 2023, which is an increase of 17.42%

*** Brussels ranked in the "Most Popular meeting cities" category of the Union of International Associations (in 2023. 2022: 1st)

4.1. International trade fairs and marketing initiatives

In 2024, visit.brussels carried out a number of initiatives with a clear objective: to promote a strong brand image for the Brussels region. To this end, the coordinated actions of visit.brussels enabled the Brussels region to secure its presence at several international trade fairs (FITUR in Madrid, ATM in Dubai, IMEX in Frankfurt) and to perpetuate its image and visibility on an international level.

At the same time, visit.brussels strengthened its positioning in the Business Events and Travel Trade markets through 39 marketing initiatives, reaching strategic targets in Belgium and Europe, along with distant markets such as the United States, the United Arab Emirates and Brazil.

These initiatives, including sales missions, workshops and networking events, generated 1,434 new contacts and 225 Business Events opportunities. By working closely with 65 partners, the destination has been able to offer tailor-made packages for conference organisers, tour operators and travel agencies.



4.2. Conference and trade show bids

visit.brussels actively canvassed and worked closely with local experts on bids to host new conferences and trade shows.

In 2024, visit.brussels intensified its efforts to position Brussels as a key destination for international conferences and trade shows.



Through the visit.brussels Convention Bureau, 37 new bids were launched, with 23 applications submitted covering a potential 43,850 participants.

Brussels won a number of conferences, including a recurring event with 5,000 participants thanks to the work on this major project. In addition, 21 technical visits were arranged to convince the organisers to choose Brussels.

The work carried out by the visit.brussels teams is boosting the region's visibility in the Business Events market and enhancing Brussels' image as a key city for large-scale business events.

4.3. Support programme

In 2024, visit.brussels strengthened the Support Programme in order to respond more effectively to the needs of B2B event organisers and promote Brussels as a destination of choice.

As part of this programme, visit.brussels provides crucial support for B2B events.

Positive Impact Support, designed as a call for projects, provided support to 11 major events, including the EFAS Congress, the World Cocoa Conference and the European Week of Regions and Cities.

Beneficiaries were able to take advantage of practical services and tailored support: STIB tickets for participants, carbon footprint studies, membership of The Association Place and access to the Press Club Brussels Europe.

The objective of building loyalty from recurring events was achieved, consolidating Brussels' position as the international capital of conferences and trade fairs. Simplifying the programme and offering tailored support helped to raise the international profile of the events supported, while aligning the offer with the challenges of sustainability and positive impact.

4.4. Ambassador Programme

In 2024, visit.brussels continued to develop its [Ambassador Programme](#). This ambitious project is designed to create a network of experts and boost Brussels' appeal for international business events, as well as promoting centres of excellence in the Brussels region.

Two major events marked 2024: the annual Ambassadors' Evening, which brought together 150 participants and showcased 12 winners and the Meet & Greet at the EAT Festival, promoting networking and the commitment of ambassadors.

The programme also generated 6 new bids to host conferences in Brussels, while improving the visibility of ambassadors with 20 profiles appearing on the web page, in addition to the 12 winners.

The strategic redesign of the ambassador database will optimise the identification of new opportunities and further bolster Brussels' influence on the international stage.



5.Events and promoting the Region

In 2024, visit.brussels helped to enhance the capital's cultural and event offering through a range of festivals and unique experiences, making a significant contribution to Brussels' attractiveness and dynamism.



* +21% vs. 2023

** -12,5% vs. 2023

*** 2023 : 9/10

5.1. Bright Festival

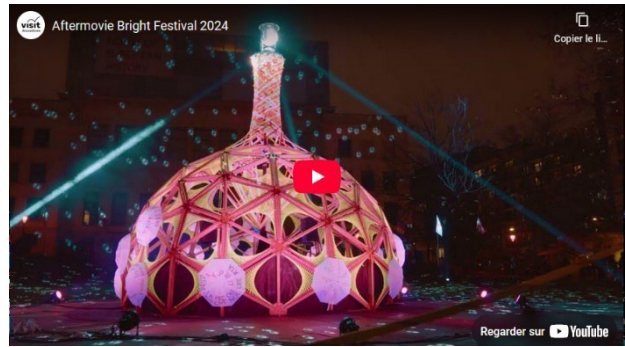
The Bright Festival has been lighting up Brussels and enhancing its architectural heritage since 2017, thanks to illuminated routes through different districts.

In 2024, the festival attracted 500,000 visitors, an increase of 25% on 2023. Year after year, this event enjoys a steady growth margin in terms of attendance and a typical satisfaction score of 8.27/10. These figures demonstrate the public's enthusiasm for this iconic event. The 2024 Bright Festival was decked out in the colours of Europe to celebrate the Belgian presidency of the Council of the European Union. To mark the occasion, some fifteen European cultural representations and embassies in Brussels took part in the event, showcasing a work by an artist from their home country. Numerous local collaborations developed a range of projects with a European theme. Finally, the festival was a great success with foreign visitors, with 90,000 tourists visiting the event.

This year's Bright Festival saw the launch of several major new additions to the programme.

- A Kids Zone opened a few hours before the festival, offered interactive, family-friendly activities for children.

- Bright Disco Night: an "after-party" organised in partnership with Pali Pali in the Ravenstein Gallery on Saturday evening, incorporated the light work on display into its luminous ambience.
- Bright Sessions, the festival's first B2B Forum, featured a full day of meetings, round tables, presentations and networking opportunities for nearly 100 lighting industry professionals, artists, event organisers, private partners and cultural representatives.



5.2. Tram experience

Launched in 2012, the Tram Experience offers a unique dining experience on board a tram specially fitted out as a gourmet restaurant and running six days a week. From January to July 2024, world cuisine (involving Italian, Japanese and French chefs) took centre stage. Then from September to December 2024, the Tram Experience gave a new generation of young Brussels chefs the opportunity to demonstrate their talents.

In 2024, the **Tram Experience** confirmed its success as an ambassador for Brussels gastronomy, with a **100% fill rate** and an **overall customer satisfaction rate of 8.69/10**. With over **6,759 customers**, including **1,650 B2B customers**, this unique experience was a brilliant showcase for internationally renowned chefs and young local talent. The renewal of strategic partnerships and the establishment of new collaborations have strengthened the project's reach and long-term sustainability, while also ensuring a balanced budget. The **Tram Experience** has become a powerful driver of appeal and visibility for Brussels.



5.3. Iris Festival

The 2024 Iris Festival was an opportunity to celebrate the 35th anniversary of the creation of the Brussels-Capital Region. This large-scale popular festival brought together all Brussels residents within their Region and invited visitors to come and enjoy the celebrations together, free of charge.

On Saturday, the Iris Festival in the Communes was the opportunity for many curious visitors to discover all the hidden secrets and gems in Schaerbeek, Evere and Saint-Josse-ten-Noode. The Art Nouveau trail in Schaerbeek, the Pieter Cnops museum in Evere and the culinary workshops in Saint-Josse-ten-Noode were particularly popular.

On Saturday evening, the Place des Palais was transformed into a giant dance floor for Iris Tipik Electro Night, with DJs Ofenbach, TRINIX, Alex Germys, Emjie and Raql. The evening was organised in partnership with RTBF (Tipik), which was responsible for the programme.

The following day, the heart of the Iris Festival moved to Brussels Park. With 7 themed villages, thousands of families enjoyed the original activities offered by Brussels' associations and institutions. Countless street artists also featured in the festivities, while not far away, the Brussels Parliament was packed with visitors.

This year, many other activities were organised over the weekend. From cycling and walking tours to guided tours of the European Quarter as part of Europe Day and the CurieuCity scientific event, there was something for everyone. Not forgetting Play Label Open Air on Place Poelaert and the open day at the Palais de Justice.

The event attracted some 9,000 people on Saturday evening and 80,000 on Sunday, despite the changeable weather conditions.



5.4. BD Comic Strip Festival

The **BD Comic Strip Festival 2024**, Belgium's flagship **9th Art event**, brought together over **70 stands**, including publishers, gallery owners, dealers and authors. The rich and varied programme included a **school day**, drawing workshops, conferences, shows, exhibitions, an international pavilion and areas dedicated to **Manga** and **alternative comics**. The

Atomium Awards were also highlighted, further enhancing the recognition of talent within the sector.

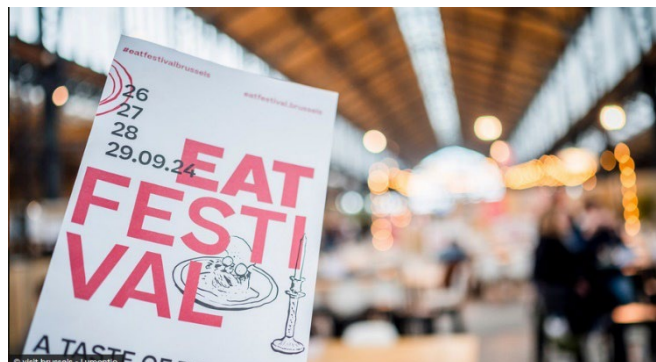
The event attracted **60,000 visitors** over three days, including around ten school groups on Friday for the school day. With own revenues reaching **€180,000**, the festival confirmed its cultural and economic impact.

The BD Comic Strip Festival remains a must-attend event for comic strip professionals and fans alike, showcasing Brussels as a capital of the **9th Art**.



5.5. EAT Festival

The EAT Festival 2024, presented in a new format, once again confirmed its status as an unmissable event, focusing on cuisine that is 100% Brussels. With over 16,000 dishes tasted, 12,000 drinks served and the involvement of 40 chefs, 8 cheese makers and 8 pastry chefs, this event celebrated culinary diversity and local artisans.



Innovation was central to the festival which featured a unique concept: eight creative teams bringing together chefs, producers and artisans, offering original and surprising collaborative menus. In partnership with BxlBeerFest, eight local breweries also enhanced the experience with food and beer pairings.

The festival enjoyed high levels of satisfaction, with a recommendation rate of 7.81/10 and partner satisfaction rate of 8.2/10. These figures reflect the positive impact of this festive and welcoming event, which continues to make its mark across Belgium.

5.6. Brussels Pride – in the capital of Europe

Brussels Pride, coordinated by visit.brussels in 2024, attracted over 210,000 participants. The event, also supported by the Wallonia-Brussels Federation, COCOF, Vlaamse Gemeenschap and Vlaamse Gemeenschapscommissie, underlined the Region's commitment to openness, inclusion and support for the LGBTQIA+ community and reinforced Brussels' image as a welcoming destination.

The **2024 event of the now unmissable Brussels Pride** was held under the banner of the Belgian presidency of the Council of the European Union, and the Pride March was delighted to invite the organisers of Europride in Thessaloniki. Several European delegations were also represented alongside the Europride float.

During **Pride Week**, a rich cultural and artistic programme, including concerts, screenings and conferences, took over several iconic venues in Brussels. On **18 May**, the Pride March, followed by artists' performances on the Mont des Arts and in the **Brussels Rainbow Village**, was the highlight of the festivities, consolidating the event's international profile.

This year's event also introduced logistical improvements, such as a new layout for the main stage and a **Safer Pride action plan**. This was developed in association with the **Sacha Plan** to ensure a safe and inclusive environment.

The event generated significant economic benefits for the hotel sector, with occupancy rates reaching **85%** on the day of the event.



6. Promoting culture

The **visit.brussels** non-profit association (ASBL) demonstrated a strong commitment to promoting culture in Brussels, with significant achievements in 2024. The diversity and richness of Brussels' cultural offerings were showcased, notably through competitions supported by the ASBL. The actions of **visit.brussels** also made a major contribution to the wider objective of decentralising tourism. These achievements are presented in this section.



985

filming days supported
in the Brussels-Capital
Region*



262.000

tickets sold via the
ticketing service (classic
ticketing and Last
Minute Tickets systems)

**



7178

Art Nouveau Passes sold

* +10% vs. 2023 : 888

** 2022 : 206.000 - 2023 : 261.000

6.1. ticketing.brussels

In terms of major developments during 2024, the last minute tickets software was integrated into the ticketing.brussels catalogue. The creation of this catalogue, made possible through ERDF funding, has enabled last minute tickets to be incorporated into this marketplace. The ticketing marketplace means that all tickets can now be purchased in one place. "Last minute tickets" has been part of the marketplace since July 2024, facilitating and enhancing its visibility.

Through its [ticketing](#) service, **visit.brussels** has made it easier to book tickets for a wide range of events. It has also expanded its online offering with a new digital ecosystem and strengthened its partnerships with iconic cultural institutions.

In 2024, no fewer than 262,000 tickets were sold through the ticketing platforms.

The Last Minute Tickets service continues to provide more widespread access to culture, offering discounted same-day tickets.

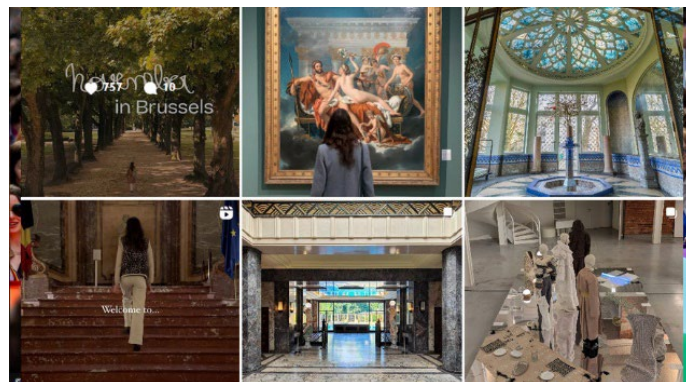
6.2. Cultural promotion

The joint cultural communication strategy is implemented by visit.brussels and supported by the COCOF, the Wallonia-Brussels Federation, the Vlaamse Gemeenschap and the Vlaamse Gemeenschapscommissie (VGC). In this context, visit.brussels concentrated the efforts of the various institutions mentioned above to promote the region's cultural offering.

The main aim of the 2024 cultural communication strategy was to coordinate the promotion and visibility of Brussels' cultural offering, to simplify access to events for citizens and tourists via the visit.brussels cultural agenda platform and to carry out targeted promotional actions. This initiative, carried out in collaboration with Réseau des Arts de Bruxelles (RAB), Brussels Kunstenoverleg (BKO), and various cultural operators in the region, achieved the following results:

- A **single database** has been created to centralise the cultural offering in open data, with **1,500 partners** publishing their events in 2024.
- **Nearly 50 key partners** use the cultural agenda via their websites, increasing its reach to local, national and international audiences: media (Brusselslife, BRUZZ, BX1, La Libre, Ket...), cultural institutions (culture.be, CBM, Muntpunt, Publiq...), public institutions (VGC, STIB, perspective.brussels...), a number of Brussels municipalities and digital screens in hotels. Paid promotional campaigns generated **2.7 million views** and **51,000 clicks**.
- Eight trilingual themed newsletters, sent out every week to **188,150 subscribers**, have also helped raise the profile of cultural events.
- All this promotional activity generated 1,040,000 active users on the agenda by visit.brussels pages, 1,650,000 sessions and 3,820,000 events viewed.

These achievements testify to our commitment to innovation, sustainability and the promotion of a rich cultural offering accessible to all, affirming Brussels' position as a dynamic and inclusive cultural capital.



6.3. Support for cultural activities and events

In 2024, Brussels hosted almost 16,000 cultural and tourist events, asserting its identity and influence on a national and international scale. At the heart of this buzz was an eclectic offering, ranging from comics and jazz to street and contemporary art.

Visit.brussels has improved its support for cultural and tourist events in Brussels by organising two biannual competitions aimed at cultural operators and event organisers. These competitions enabled **54 winners** to benefit from a lamppost poster campaign with **50 units**, worth **€6,000** each, giving increased visibility to a rich and diverse programme.

Key results:

- **Applications:** 46 applications received for the first competition (39 admissible) and 53 for the second (51 admissible).
- **Winners:** A wide range of events were supported, covering disciplines as diverse as jazz, design, contemporary art, cinema, gastronomy and heritage, including iconic festivals such as Museum Night Fever, the Queen Elisabeth Competition, Couleur Café, Art Brussels, Zinneke Parade, Brosella Festival and the Flower Carpet, along with emerging events.
- In terms of quality, in addition to the criteria of attractiveness, scale and image of the Region, the jury also assessed the applications based on key factors with a positive impact. These included the duration of the event, its contribution to citizenship, inclusion, sustainability, employment and its local roots, as well as its ability to bring together different venues, associations and municipalities in Brussels.



6.4. Developing cultural experiences

With the organisation of the "[Bruxelles sur Scènes](#)" festival in collaboration with the COCOF, visit.brussels promoted the city's intimate and often little-known cultural offerings by turning the spotlight on Brussels' cafés-théâtres and offering a varied programme of shows in different neighbourhoods. 515 "Bruxelles sur scènes" passes were sold in 2024. At the same time, a new visual identity was promoted through a communications campaign, revealing these exceptional locations.

Visit.brussels also celebrated the diversity of Brussels' heritage through a number of large-scale initiatives, such as the extension of its "Art Nouveau" initiative by continuing to sell "Art Nouveau Passes". These passes have been a great success, with no fewer than 7,178 passes sold. In 2024, visit.brussels added a new "Brussels Art Guide 2024", to its collection of tools for promoting culture. Lastly, visit.brussels organised a number of promotional campaigns to mark the [100th anniversary of the birth of the Surrealist movement](#).

Meanwhile, support for the Brussels Renaissance Festival and the Ommegang served to highlight the attractiveness and richness of Brussels' historical and architectural heritage.



6.5. Film Commission

In 2024, Brussels once again established itself as an attractive location for film shoots, thanks to its quality welcome, diverse settings and rich gastronomic and hotel heritage.

The visit.brussels Film Commission played a pivotal role in supporting 308 productions, totalling 1,032 shooting days and attracting projects from 16 different countries, including 49 international shoots with famous actors. This activity not only stimulated the local economy by boosting the hospitality and services sector, but also helped to strengthen Brussels' territorial marketing. In addition, it contributed to the decentralisation of film activities in the Brussels region, since several projects were carried out in the nineteen municipalities of our capital.



7.Capital of Europe

In 2024, visit.brussels deployed a range of actions to promote Brussels as a European capital and international business centre. Below is a summary of the main initiatives supported.



* +5% vs. 2023
** +224% vs 2023: 256 participants attended in person
*** -35,14% vs 2023 : 185 partners

7.1. Increasing the attractiveness of the European Quarter

In 2024, visit.brussels increased its efforts to promote the European Quarter by strengthening its appeal, dynamism, image and integration into local life.

The development of the **European Quarter Brussels (EUQB)** brand was central to these initiatives, featuring a major communications campaign. The campaign, which combined posters, social media, postcards, promotional videos and digital advertising displays, was designed to highlight the human and welcoming aspect of the district.

To bolster the brand's visual identity, cylindrical elements bearing its logo were installed on regional signage. In addition, a communications competition saw eight winners, event organisers in the district, benefit from increased visibility through advertising packages. A media specialist was also hired to maximise the brand's presence in the public space (through sponsored or free conventions).

At the same time, visit.brussels held two **EQ Connect** round tables, bringing together 120 participants in June and December. These meetings, organised in partnership with the Office of the Commissioner for Europe, were an opportunity to work with partners and review the district's promotion and issues related to its European dimension. A **GT Tourisme** meeting also brought together European institutions and local players to

discuss tourism and urban planning developments in the area. These actions involved a wide range of target groups, including local residents, businesses, cultural operators and visitors, with a view to revitalising the district while guaranteeing a quality living environment and local balance.

Through these initiatives, visit.brussels has boosted the awareness of the EUQB brand, consolidated relations with local and international stakeholders and improved the perception of the European Quarter as a dynamic and welcoming space in the heart of Brussels.



7.2. The Association Place

In 2024, visit.brussels continued its commitment to consolidate Brussels' role as a key hub for international associations and MICE (Meetings, Incentives, Conferences and Exhibitions) activities. Through **local and international strategic partnerships**, the aim has been to promote Brussels as a destination of choice for associations, while actively supporting their development in the area.



Since February 2024, the **Association Place**, which opened in November 2023, has become increasingly important with the launch of the **Association Connect** programme. This is a series of monthly interactive workshops designed to meet the specific needs of international associations, with very positive feedback on the relevance of the topics addressed and the quality of the speakers.

Efforts to promote **The Association Place** include social networking campaigns, "open house" sessions and "welcome days" to familiarise Brussels-based international associations with the services offered by the **Convention & Association Bureau**.

Partnerships with associations, supported by the European Quarter brands and collaborations with organisations such as the **Press Club** and the **CEOI**, have helped to raise Brussels' international profile. Through these actions, visit.brussels has consolidated its relations with local and international associations. It has also positioned Brussels as a strategic centre for exchanges and events with associations.

7.3. Press Club

In 2024, the Press Club Brussels Europe continued to play a central role as a key platform for international journalists, representatives of European institutions and international organisations. With over 500 events, including press conferences, debates, seminars, exhibitions and workshops, the Press Club confirmed its position as Europe's leading communications hub. In November, a record was set with over 50 events in a single month, despite a pre-election period in May and June which slowed down some European Parliament-related activities.

With an average daily attendance of 80 people in the workspaces and lounge and 4,800 monthly visitors to the "Discover Brussels" section of the website (50% of whom are from outside Belgium), the Press Club has improved its reach. Its role in the EU Visitors Programme led it to welcome some thirty international journalists in 2024, consolidating its status as a dynamic platform for discussion and communication. Thanks to these numerous initiatives, the Press Club continues to promote Brussels as a nerve centre for the international press and cultural diplomacy.



7.4. Europe Direct

In 2024 as part of its *Europe Direct Brussels* mission with the European Union, visit.brussels established itself as an key information centre on the European Union (EU) in the Region, bringing Europe closer to Brussels' residents. The initiative raised awareness among a wide range of audiences about the EU, how it works and what it does, through a website, dynamic social media accounts and information via visit.brussels offices. A communication campaign on social networks with filmed portraits of European civil servants gave the institutions a human face.

At the same time, a number of events have strengthened the dialogue with citizens. An interactive roadshow reached out to young people directly on the topic of the European elections, attracting 455 participants. The Iris Festival, the SIEP trade fair, local community events and the *Pop-Up Europe* programme all featured debates and fun activities. Education was one of the major focuses, with a *special Teachers' Day*, the distribution of teaching materials and classroom activities for 415 pupils.

This communication plan had a significant impact for Europe Direct: 50 presentations, 830 event participants, strong social media growth (71,100 people reached on Instagram, 43,552 on Facebook) and a good engagement rate on newsletters.



7.5. Welcoming expatriates

In 2024, visit.brussels continued its commitment to welcoming and integrating the international community in Brussels, through personalised support and by facilitating their daily immersion in local and cultural life.

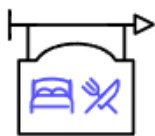
The *Destination Brussels* event brought together several thousand newcomers within the European institutions and NATO, offering them digital [Welcome Packs](#) containing free Villo subscriptions and a *Volume Pass* to discover the city. A total of 170 [Volume Passes](#) and 132 *Villo Passes* have been used (excluding data for the last quarter).

Nine welcome sessions attracted 400 participants in-person while 600 attended online. A stand at NATO extended the reach of our actions to international communities.

A monthly newsletter, with 8,000 subscribers and an open rate of 30 to 37%, has helped maintain a regular link with this community.

These initiatives have benefited around 2,500 new expatriates every six months, as well as the 8,000 already settled here, actively contributing to their integration and discovery of Brussels.

8. Sustainability, diversity, equity and inclusion (DEI)



45%

of hotel rooms eco-labelled*



44

Partner infrastructures
certified Access-I in
2024**



20

Accommodation
certified Bike Friendly in
2024***

* +6 points vs.2023

** +15% vs. 2023 : 38

*** -35% vs. 2023 : 31

8.1. Sustainability

Brussels is establishing itself as a sustainable European capital by accommodating green spaces, the circular economy and soft mobility. visit.brussels is playing a key role in this transition by raising awareness among tourism stakeholders and promoting responsible practices to enhance the visitor experience while reducing environmental impact.

In 2024, visit.brussels continued this commitment by participating in the Global Destination Sustainability-Index (GDS-Index), where Brussels ranked 45th out of over 100 destinations with a score of 69.6%. This ranking is used to assess progress and identify areas for improvement.

The eco-responsibility of tourism infrastructures has been further strengthened by the Green Key label, which singles out establishments committed to exemplary environmental management. In partnership with GoodPlanet, Canopea, the Brussels Hotels Association and Brussels Museums, visit.brussels contributed to the accreditation of 70 infrastructures in 2024.

To support the sustainable transition for events, a best practice guide has been developed for conference and festival organisers. It suggests practical solutions for reducing the environmental footprint in terms of mobility, energy, food and waste management.

Cycling tourism was also a key focus area: visit.brussels supported the EuroVelo network, participated in the *Tourism on Bike* webinar, and, after observing a decline in Bike Friendly label certifications in 2024, will invest in strengthening and sustaining the

promotion of the label in order to improve the reception of cycling tourists. A digital campaign was also launched on RouteYou to facilitate access to cycling routes.

Through these initiatives, Brussels is positioning itself as a model destination for eco-friendly tourism, combining attractiveness with an environmental commitment.

8.2. Diversity

The commitment to accessible and inclusive tourism, aimed at guaranteeing an optimal welcome for all, including people with disabilities, is a fundamental value passionately supported by visit.brussels. In 2024, through a number of strategic initiatives, the objective has been to improve the accessibility of tourist infrastructures and events, while raising awareness of the importance of this approach among the sector's stakeholders.

Access-i, a reference tool in terms of infrastructure accessibility, enables tourist infrastructures in Brussels to benefit from an audit and certification confirming their level of accessibility. In 2024, 9 new partners were supported in this process, bringing the total number of certified facilities to 44, including accommodation, museums and attractions. In addition, three major events - the Bright Festival, the Iris Festival and Brussels Pride - received special support to ensure that their facilities were adapted for people with reduced mobility. This approach is part of our drive to offer an inclusive experience, taking into account the specific needs of visitors with disabilities and promoting tourism that is truly open to all.

In addition, visit.brussels has consolidated its role within the **International Social Tourism Organisation (ISTO)**, playing an active part in the discussions of the working group on accessible tourism. The resulting recommendations have been incorporated into internal communications, the [website](#) and Quality Academy newsletters and training courses. This promotes a wider dissemination of best practices in terms of accessibility.

The value of inclusiveness, evident in every one of our actions, is also expressed through certain specific actions. **Brussels Pride-In the Capital of Europe** (210,000 participants in 2024) is a showcase for the international and national LGBTQIA+ community, raising its profile while defending equality and human rights during a festive day accessible to all. Similarly, [La démente Anniversary](#) is the perfect festive setting for members of the LGBTQIA+ community in the capital: the success of this iconic event remains stable year on year and, together with the Pride event, generates significant economic benefits in the Brussels region, particularly in terms of hotel occupancy.

Throughout the year, visit.brussels orchestrates a significant number of unifying events, aimed at absolutely all audiences. It also ensures the neutrality of the images conveyed and the absence of gender stereotypes in both its communication campaigns and promotional materials.

9. Specific visit.brussels missions

In 2024, visit.brussels carried out a number of specific missions to enrich the Brussels experience, demonstrating the association's commitment to innovation, culture and sustainable tourism.



* steady figure vs 2023: 15,000 visitors

** steady figure vs 2023: 150,000 visitors

9.1. Belgian presidency of the Council of the European Union

Belgium's presidency of the Council of the European Union in 2024 was a unique opportunity to boost Brussels' international profile and enhance its role as European capital. Throughout the year, visit.brussels deployed a series of **cross-cutting initiatives** designed to improve the attractiveness of the European Quarter, promote the destination to international audiences and support professional and cultural events in relation to this presidency.

One of the major projects was the development of the [“European Quarter Brussels” \(EUQB\) brand](#), consolidated by a local awareness campaign, renewed signage and a communications competition targeting event organisers in the district. The "Still Alive After Five" campaign, which highlighted the vibrancy of the European Quarter after office hours, helped to firmly establish this new identity. The brand also benefited from increased visibility through a digital campaign that generated 4.8 million impressions and 5,539 clicks.

In line with an enhanced **city marketing** strategy, visit.brussels launched a six-month multimedia campaign, entitled [“Real Secrets, Real Brussels”](#), aimed at international audiences present in the capital during the presidency. With 9.4 million impressions, 1.2

million competed video plays and over 79,000 visits to the dedicated landing page, this campaign effectively positioned Brussels as a lively, authentic destination.

As part of the **Europe Direct** programme, a roadshow was organised across Brussels to raise awareness among 400 young people of the impact of the European Union on their daily lives and the importance of voting.

In addition, two major European events were incorporated into the presidency's dynamic:

- The **Bright Brussels Festival**, which welcomed 484,795 visitors and showcased 11 works arising from partnerships with European countries, strengthening cultural cooperation. A day of "Bright Sessions" conferences brought together 100 industry professionals to discuss the challenges of lighting design and event sustainability.
- **Belgian Pride**, which saw 200,000 participants and welcomed a European Europride float, supported by delegations from six European countries. A B2B conference was also organised on "The meaning of Prides", attended by 70 international professionals and experts.
- Finally, visit.brussels played a key role in boosting the Meetings Industry by organising the official event "**EU Dialogue - Driving Positive Change in the Meetings Industry**". With 180 participants, 52 speakers and 15 nationalities present, the conference produced a sector manifesto for the new European Commission and Members of the European Parliament, highlighting the priorities of the events industry in Europe.

With these ambitious, targeted initiatives, visit.brussels has taken full advantage of the Belgian presidency of the European Union to raise Brussels' profile, promote its attractiveness to international visitors and support structuring events for its positioning as the European capital.

9.2. Gourmet roadshow in Lausanne

From 18 to 20 May 2024, as part of an initiative to promote Brussels craftsmanship supported by the Wallonia-Brussels Federation, visit.brussels helped promote Brussels internationally, highlighting its gastronomic artisans.

In this context, the MIAM Festival in Lausanne chose to invite Brussels as its guest of honour for the 2024 event. The event showcased the attractions of the Belgian capital and included presentations of Brussels gastronomic specialities and a Brussels Farmers market. The event attracted **50,000** visitors and helped forge special links between the capital of the Vaud and our capital.

9.3. I Love Science Festival

The *I Love Science Festival* (ILSF) has established itself as a flagship event for science communication in Brussels. Held from 11 to 13 October at Tour & Taxis, it attracted over **15,000 visitors**, confirming the public's enthusiasm for science and innovation.

This sixth event featured **60 exhibitors**, **77 interactive stands** divided into **7 themed villages** and **160 events** over a surface area of **11,500 m²**. Highlights included science shows, a conference on artificial intelligence and a travelling performance with animated dinosaurs. An area dedicated to toddlers was new this year, encouraging scientific awareness from an early age.

There was a strong response from schools, with **2,700 pupils** registered for Friday activities and a full fill rate for the time slots. The event received a **96% satisfaction rate** from teachers for its organisation and **87% positive feedback** on the programme.

In terms of communication, the festival enjoyed **high media visibility**, generating **1.4 million impressions** on RTBF, **132,912 views** on BX1 and over 75,000 on Bruzz. A digital campaign reached **60,903 users** on Instagram, boosting its profile.

The 2024 event attracted **67% of new visitors**, mostly from Brussels and scored a rating of **8.34/10 in recommendations**. The exhibitors were unanimous: **100% said that they were satisfied** with the organisation and the link between science and the programme.

With its immersive format and educational impact, the ILSF continues to inspire younger generations and strengthen Brussels's position as a capital of scientific innovation.



9.4. Batibouw

In 2024, the Brussels-Capital Region reaffirmed its commitment to sustainable construction, renovation and housing by actively participating in Batibouw, Belgium's largest trade fair dedicated to the sector. This unmissable event, which attracted 150,000 visitors this year, is an essential platform for informing homeowners, tenants and future residents about the grants, loans, public projects and housing solutions offered by the Region.

The Region's stand welcomed more than 1,000 visitors, offering personalised advice and detailed information on the various forms of assistance available. With the presence of numerous partners and public-interest organisations, visitors were able to get clear answers to their questions and learn about schemes that support access to housing in Brussels.

The 2024 Batibouw event enhanced the visibility of regional initiatives, while fostering dialogue between citizens and housing stakeholders. The partners who attended expressed great satisfaction with the collaboration and the impact of their participation, underlining the importance of this annual meeting to offer better support to the people of Brussels in their real estate projects.



9.5. Hiring the BIP

The BIP Meeting Centre, home of the Brussels-Capital Region is ideally located on Place Royale, in the heart of the historic centre of Brussels. It provides an exceptional setting where local and international associations and companies can hold events and meetings.

In 2024, this prestigious venue for hire experienced remarkable success, holding 150 events and marking the impact of a new commercial approach implemented by visit.brussels. This strategy led to a 14% rise in sales, due in particular to an increase in bookings by private companies.

As part of an environmental responsibility approach, visit.brussels is proud to have renewed its Green Key label for a further three years, confirming the BIP Meeting Centre's commitment to sustainable, eco-responsible event management.



9.6. Promoting artisans

In 2024, *visit.brussels* improved its promotion of Brussels' gastronomic crafts through the EAT Festival. This event brought together over 40 chefs, 8 cheese makers, 8 pastry chefs and some twenty local producers. The event's success is evident in its particularly glowing results: 16,000 dishes tasted, 12,000 drinks served and an 83% visitor retention rate.

The Farmers' Market and the partnership with BxlBeerFest showcased local expertise, notably through 8 craft breweries. Satisfaction was high, with an overall partner rating of 8.2/10. The festival therefore confirms its key role in promoting Brussels' culinary heritage and enhancing the city's appeal.



9.7. 2024, centenary of the surrealist art movement

In 2024, to celebrate the centenary of Surrealism, *visit.brussels* implemented an ambitious strategy to promote this iconic cultural heritage, both in Brussels and internationally. Through communication campaigns, museum collaborations and cultural events, the Belgian capital affirmed its central role in the history of Surrealism.



A **digital and media campaign** targeting France and Spain generated **19.5 million impressions**, **13,300 clicks** and **4,700 visits** to the [dedicated webpage](#). Audience analysis revealed a strong interest in the museum and heritage offer from the **35 and over** age group, particularly those aged **55 and over**.

Visit.brussels brought together major institutions such as the **Magritte Museum, Bozar and KBR** and launched an immersive online tour entitled "*Surrealist Brussels, a way of life*". A **press trip** attracted **41 international journalists**, generating **77 articles** and media coverage valued at **€958,424**.

Thanks to this global approach, Brussels has strengthened its international cultural positioning and laid the foundations for a sustainable strategy to promote its surrealist heritage.

9.8. Collaboration with the municipality of Ganshoren

In line with its objective of decentralising tourism in the Brussels Region, visit.brussels signed an agreement to help the municipality of Ganshoren establish a tourism and cultural action plan for 2025-2028 period. The municipality wants to develop local tourism and its offer by implementing a strategic action plan for the coming years.

Indirectly, it aims to improve its position in the tourism market, develop employment and transform its image from a mere stopping-off place into a destination in its own right.

This support was part of a co-constructive approach, through the active involvement and validation of local stakeholders, the municipality and neighbouring municipalities, guaranteeing genuine support.

As a result, a detailed action plan, flexible in terms of actions, timetable and funding, has been produced and submitted. In the short term, this will promote Art Deco and the Basilica through the swift launch of a cooperation initiative among the municipalities to the north-west of the capital. In the medium and long term, initiatives focusing on modernism, castles and garden districts will evolve, while the green network will gradually be expanded.

A total of 24 actions are proposed, with effective cost control possible. The business model is also based on partnerships, pay-what-you-can initiatives and voluntary contributions. The financial impact, estimated at between €1,300 and €200,000 per action, means that investments can be adapted. The approach favours sustainable actions rather than one-off events.

This initiative has created a real dynamic between the municipalities of Brussels, inspiring other potential projects. It illustrates visit.brussels' key role in the development of integrated, sustainable tourism (beneficial to visitors, residents, shopkeepers and the environment), while helping to limit over tourism in the very centre of the city.



